

E-Business Life Cycle

Business Planning and Strategizing (1)

Strategizing

- Know Your Audience
- Become Internet Savvy
- Determine Long-term vs. Short-term Selling
- Define Your Competitors
- Evaluate Website Appearance
- Select Product Range
- Manage Transaction Effectively & Efficiently
- Design Shipment Process
- Be Prepared for Unexpected Changes

Ultimate Strategy

- Vision
 - What is your business trying to achieve?
- Resources
 - How much can your business afford to build the right Website?
- Culture
 - Is your business politically amenable for coordinating efforts to support e-business?

Deciding on Type of Web Site

- Clearly defined goals keep your priorities in perspective
- Some main goals for Web sites are:
 - Marketing
 - Online sales and service
 - Information delivery
 - Customer support

Technology Infrastructure (2)

Software Issues

- eCommerce on the Internet requires basic software
 - File transfer protocol (FTP)
 - Remote Console
 - VNC
 - Search capabilities
 - NetNews -- RSS feeds
 - E-mail
 - Broadband connection (DSL, Cable, or Wireless)
 - A browser
 - IE, FireFox, Opera, Safari

Security

- Security is the critical backdrop that must be in place for every step to work
- Security is the protection of data, software, or hardware against accidental or intentional damage from a defined threat
- Three types of security risk:
 - *Document security* entails the integrity of the Web site and its information
 - *Customer privacy* has to do with embedding devices in the visitor's hard disk to track site usage
 - *System security* deals with the way the network, the Web server, and the e-commerce infrastructure prevent unauthorized access and tampering with e-commerce traffic

Security Rules

- Control access to web server
- Update server software & encoding security measures
- Use firewalls
- Monitor traffic & detect irregularities
- Assign a webmaster

Design Phase (3)

Web Site Design Issues

- User control and freedom
- Consistency and standards
- Recognition rather than recall
- Efficient design
- Recovery from error
- Help desk

Attributes of the Web Storefront

- Customers should be able to find the product quickly
- The site should have mechanisms to process the order and send it to the fulfillment center for quick and secure packing and shipping
- The site should have mechanisms to generate a summary of the order and produce a printable receipt

Software Program Cluster Components

- Database Server
- Store Administrator
- Catalog Builder
- Shopping Cart

The Marketing Phase (4)

- Providing good site service
 - Advertising
 - Know your customer
 - Making the sale
 - Stock control
 - Collecting the cash
 - Delivering the goods and following up
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- Order-processing System

The Fulfillment Phase (5)

- Fulfillment is what happens after a sale is made
 - Packing up the merchandise
 - Shipping the merchandise
 - Answering questions about the order
 - Sending out the bill or verifying e-payment
 - Following up to see if the customer is satisfied
- Fulfillment is honoring a commitment to deliver goods or services after payment has been assured

Fulfillment Issues

- Product availability
- Matching the products for sale to the products in the inventory
 - Out-of-stock notice
 - Back orders
- Processing orders
- Controls

The Maintenance and Enhancement Phase (6)

- Maintenance means keeping a system or business on course, based on the initial design or plan
- The goal of maintenance is to ensure the usability of the Web site
- Enhancement means implementing upgrades or changes that are designed to improve the system's productivity
- The goal of enhancement is to upgrade the Web site and the business-to-consumer connection to meet the latest standards and customer expectations